



Solutions.
People.
Energy.SM

SPE AFRICA GEOTHERMAL DATATHON 2026

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

1. General Information

What is the SPE Africa Geothermal Datathon?

The SPE Africa Geothermal Datathon 2026 is the third datathon hosted by SPE DSEATS (Data Science and Engineering Analytics Technical Section) Africa Region. This is the first-ever geothermal-focused datathon, designed to challenge participants to apply data science techniques to real-world geothermal energy problems.

When and where is the datathon taking place?

The datathon will run as part of the SPE Africa Annual Student Congress (SAASC) 2026, hosted at Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Kenya from July 22-24, 2026. The kick-off session will be held virtually on May 11, 2026.

Why should I participate?

Participants will gain:

- Practical experience applying data science techniques to geothermal processes
- A clear understanding of geothermal energy systems and workflows
- Teamwork experience solving time-bound technical challenges
- Networking opportunities with industry professionals from GDC, KenGen, and SPE
- Recognition from SPE and potential career opportunities in the geothermal sector

2. Registration & Eligibility

Who can participate?

The datathon is open to university students and early-career professionals across Africa with an interest in energy, data science, geoscience, or engineering. No prior geothermal experience is required; just curiosity and willingness to learn.

How do I register?



Solutions.
People.
Energy.SM

Registration can be done via <https://forms.gle/uK7EesMfKmN5ffhj8>. If you have already registered and received a confirmation email, you are officially enrolled. If you have not received confirmation, contact speafricageodatathon@gmail.com.

Is there a registration fee?

Participation in the datathon itself is free. However, if you plan to attend SAASC 2026 in person at Kenyatta University (July 22-24) you will be required to cater for your transport and accommodation. If you are coming from outside Kenya, kindly register via

3. Team Formation

Do I need to have a team to participate?

Yes, all submissions must be made as part of a team. Teams must consist of 3-5 members. If you do not have a team, you will be added to a pool of participants from which teams can be formed during the kick-off session.

Can I form a team with members from different universities or countries?

Absolutely. Cross-institutional and cross-border teams are encouraged to promote collaboration across the African energy community.

What if I already have a team?

If you have already formed a team (3-5 members), you will be instructed on how to submit your result as a team.

4. The Challenge

What is the datathon challenge?

The specific challenge will be revealed during the kick-off session on May 11, 2026. It will involve analyzing geothermal data and solving a real-world problem related to geothermal energy exploration, reservoir characterization, or production optimization in an East African context.

What data will be provided?

Teams will receive curated datasets related to the challenge during the kick-off session. This may include geological, geophysical, geochemical, or production data. Data sources and formats will be clearly specified.



What tools or software should we use?

You are free to use any programming language or software tools you prefer (Python, R, MATLAB, Excel, etc.). However, Python is recommended due to its widespread use in data science and the availability of geoscience libraries. Your final submission should include code, analysis, and a presentation of findings.

5. Timeline & Deadlines

What is the timeline for the datathon?

Key dates:

- May 11, 2026: Virtual kick-off session (challenge reveal, data release, team formation support)
- May 11 - June 4, 2026: Working period (teams analyze data and develop solutions)
- June 4, 2026: Final submission deadline (code, report, presentation slides)
- July 22-24, 2026: SAASC 2026 at Kenyatta University (finalist presentations, judging, awards)

What time is the kick-off session on May 11?

The exact time will be communicated via email to all registered participants. The session will be recorded for those unable to attend live. Meeting access link will be shared at least 24 hours before the session.

Can we submit late?

Late submissions will not be accepted. Plan to submit at least 24 hours before the deadline to account for any technical issues. Extensions will only be granted in exceptional circumstances with prior approval from the organizing committee.

6. Submissions & Judging

What should our final submission include?

This will be outlined in the challenge description documentation that will be shared after the Kick Off session.

How will submissions be judged?

Submissions will be evaluated based on:



Solutions.
People.
Energy.SM

- Technical rigor and correctness of analysis
- Innovation and creativity in approach
- Clarity of documentation and presentation
- Practical applicability to geothermal operations in Africa

Will finalists present at SAASC 2026?

Yes. The top teams will be invited to present their solutions for final judging in person at SAASC 2026 (July 22-24) at Kenyatta University. Virtual presentation options may be available for teams unable to travel.

7. Support & Resources

I don't have a background in geothermal energy. Can I still participate?

Absolutely. The datathon is designed to be a learning experience. Background materials relevant to the challenge will be provided during the kick-off session. Your data science skills are more important than prior geothermal knowledge.

Will we have access to mentors or support during the competition?

Yes. Office hours and Q&A sessions will be scheduled throughout the working period. You can also ask questions via email (speafricageodatathon@gmail.com) or through a dedicated communication channel (details shared during kick-off).

Where can I find additional geothermal resources?

Recommended resources:

- SPE OnePetro library (geothermal papers and case studies)
- GDC Kenya and KenGen technical reports
- International Geothermal Association (IGA) publications
- Python libraries: pandas, numpy, matplotlib, scikit-learn etc.

8. Prizes & Recognition

What are the prizes?

Prize details will be announced during the kick-off session. Winning teams will receive recognition from SPE, certificates. All finalists will be featured in SPE communications.

Will I receive a certificate of participation?



Solutions.
People.
Energy.SM

Yes. All participants who submit a complete solution will receive a digital certificate of participation. Finalists and winners will receive special recognition certificates.

9. Contact & Additional Information

Who do I contact if I have more questions?

Email: speafricageodatathon@gmail.com All inquiries will be answered within 48 hours. For urgent matters during the kick-off session, use the live Q&A feature.

[About SPE DSEATS](#)

[About SPE GTTS](#)

Can we use external datasets or APIs?

You may use publicly available supplementary data to enhance your analysis, but your core solution must be based on the provided challenge dataset. Clearly cite all external sources in your report.

We look forward to your participation in shaping the future of geothermal energy in Africa.

SPE Africa Geothermal Datathon Organizing Committee